

# Top 50 Franchises Under \$200K

The lowest-cost franchises with real operating scale — ranked by total investment, drawn from 2026 state-filed FDDs.

## How to read this list

These are the 50 franchises with the lowest **total initial investment** (Item 7 of the FDD) that still operate at meaningful scale — at least 50 outlets — so you're looking at proven systems, not untested concepts. The cheapest on the list starts around **\$1,945** total investment.

**A low entry price is a starting point, not a verdict.** Total investment tells you what it costs to open — not what you'll earn, how hard the work is, or how strong the franchisor's support is. Use this list to build a shortlist, then do the real diligence: read each brand's full FDD, run the cost calculator, and call current franchisees from the Item 20 list. Every brand below links to its full data page.

What each entry shows: **Total investment** = Item 7 low–high range. **Initial fee** = the upfront franchise fee (a subset of total investment). **Royalty** = ongoing % of revenue. **Outlets** = most recent Item 20 system count. "Item 19 disclosed" means the franchisor published financial-performance data you can review on the brand page. Figures are extracted verbatim from each brand's most recent FDD; see the methodology at [franchisedepth.com/methodology/](https://franchisedepth.com/methodology/).

*Not financial, legal, or investment advice. FranchiseDepth is not affiliated with any franchisor listed. Per FTC 16 CFR §436.5, only a franchisor's own FDD is an authoritative source for its terms.*

## Under \$50,000

### 1 Cruise Planners Retail Services

Total investment \$1,945 – \$20,505 Initial fee \$695 Royalty 2% Outlets 9,374 · **Item 19 disclosed**

### 2 Jazzercise Fitness Wellness

Total investment \$2,170 – \$2,965 Initial fee \$625 Royalty 20% Outlets 15,276

### 3 Sign Gypsies Retail Services

Total investment \$4,150 – \$9,900 Initial fee \$1,000 Royalty — Outlets 1,695

### 4 Padgett Business Services Tax Financial

Total investment \$8,700 – \$84,920 Initial fee \$3,500 Royalty 9% Outlets 492 · **Item 19 disclosed**

### 5 Card My Yard Home Services Outdoor

Total investment \$10,350 – \$18,550 Initial fee \$8,500 Royalty 25%  
Outlets 1,474 · **Item 19 disclosed**

### 6 CruiseOne Retail Services

Total investment \$12,295 – \$20,695 Initial fee \$495 Royalty 2% Outlets 5,030 · **Item 19 disclosed**

### 7 Coverall Home Services Cleaning

Total investment \$17,986 – \$64,280 Initial fee \$15,570 Royalty 5%  
Outlets 17,007 · **Item 19 disclosed**

**8 Bento Sushi** Food Quick Service

Total investment \$20,200 – \$145,550 Initial fee \$2,000 Royalty 10% Outlets 191

---

**9 American Poolplayers Association** Home Services Outdoor

Total investment \$22,220 – \$30,759 Initial fee \$10,000 Royalty 20% Outlets 1,072

---

**10 CARSTAR** Automotive Services

Total investment \$23,500 – \$165,300 Initial fee \$10,000 Royalty 6% Outlets 1,413

---

**11 Grout Doctor** Home Services Cleaning

Total investment \$24,065 – \$38,085 Initial fee \$15,000 Royalty — Outlets 238 · **Item 19 disclosed**

---

**12 JPAR - Real Estate** Real Estate

Total investment \$26,780 – \$267,300 Initial fee \$10,000 Royalty — Outlets 159

---

**13 FujiSan** Food Quick Service

Total investment \$28,183 – \$104,055 Initial fee \$500 Royalty — Outlets 2,319

---

**14 DESTINATION ATHLETE®** Retail Services

Total investment \$28,300 – \$108,610 Initial fee \$20,000 Royalty — Outlets 888

---

**15 Maui Wowi** Food Quick Service

Total investment \$28,900 – \$279,050 Initial fee \$30,000 Royalty — Outlets 225

---

**16 JDog Junk Removal & Hauling** Pet Services

Total investment \$30,000 – \$187,250 Initial fee \$10,000 Royalty — Outlets 188

---

**17 Better Homes and Gardens Real Estate** Real Estate

Total investment \$33,970 – \$269,300 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 5% Outlets 1,086

---

**18 H&R Block** Tax Financial

Total investment \$34,080 – \$158,750 Initial fee \$2,500 Royalty — Outlets 19,363

---

**19 ERA** Real Estate

Total investment \$34,470 – \$266,900 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 6% Outlets 1,302

---

**20 Freeway Insurance®** Tax Financial

Total investment \$34,950 – \$84,000 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 14% Outlets 1,439 · **Item 19 disclosed**

---

**21 CENTURY 21** Real Estate

Total investment \$35,770 – \$286,100 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 6% Outlets 5,055

---

**22 Coldwell Banker Commercial®** Real Estate

Total investment \$37,050 – \$553,700 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 6% Outlets 270

---

|           |                                       |                          |                                                                                   |                      |             |                                        |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>23</b> | <b>REMAX</b>                          | Real Estate              | Total investment \$37,100 – \$336,500                                             | Initial fee \$8,750  | Royalty 1%  | Outlets 5,988                          |
| <b>24</b> | <b>City Lifestyle</b>                 | Retail Services          | Total investment \$37,600 – \$46,350                                              | Initial fee \$20,000 | Royalty 7%  | Outlets 705 · <b>Item 19 disclosed</b> |
| <b>25</b> | <b>HOODZ</b>                          | Home Services Cleaning   | Total investment \$38,088 – \$246,807<br>Outlets 419 · <b>Item 19 disclosed</b>   | Initial fee \$23,920 | Royalty 10% |                                        |
| <b>26</b> | <b>ProColor Collision</b>             | Automotive Services      | Total investment \$38,300 – \$199,500                                             | Initial fee \$10,000 | Royalty 3%  | Outlets 74                             |
| <b>27</b> | <b>Mosquito Authority</b>             | Home Services Outdoor    | Total investment \$39,000 – \$128,700<br>Outlets 1,565 · <b>Item 19 disclosed</b> | Initial fee \$25,000 | Royalty 10% |                                        |
| <b>28</b> | <b>National Property Inspections</b>  | Home Services Inspection | Total investment \$41,000 – \$54,950                                              | Initial fee \$26,175 | Royalty 8%  | Outlets 582 · <b>Item 19 disclosed</b> |
| <b>29</b> | <b>Soccer Shots</b>                   | Education                | Total investment \$42,950 – \$54,300                                              | Initial fee \$30,925 | Royalty 7%  | Outlets 984                            |
| <b>30</b> | <b>Brightway Insurance</b>            | Tax Financial            | Total investment \$43,425 – \$186,900<br>Outlets 1,059 · <b>Item 19 disclosed</b> | Initial fee \$25,000 | Royalty —   |                                        |
| <b>31</b> | <b>Howard Hanna</b>                   | Real Estate              | Total investment \$45,000 – \$258,500                                             | Initial fee \$25,000 | Royalty —   | Outlets 970                            |
| <b>32</b> | <b>Snelling</b>                       | Staffing Employment      | Total investment \$45,000 – \$147,750                                             | Initial fee \$2,500  | Royalty —   | Outlets 228                            |
| <b>33</b> | <b>RooterMan</b>                      | Home Services Plumbing   | Total investment \$45,075 – \$82,475                                              | Initial fee \$4,975  | Royalty —   | Outlets 1,551                          |
| <b>34</b> | <b>Aire-Master</b>                    | Home Services HVAC       | Total investment \$46,234 – \$171,400<br>Outlets 148 · <b>Item 19 disclosed</b>   | Initial fee \$30,000 | Royalty 5%  |                                        |
| <b>35</b> | <b>Sotheby's International Realty</b> | Real Estate              | Total investment \$47,250 – \$331,950                                             | Initial fee \$0      | Royalty 6%  | Outlets 2,090                          |
| <b>36</b> | <b>Realty ONE Group</b>               | Real Estate              | Total investment \$47,250 – \$227,500                                             | Initial fee \$19,000 | Royalty —   | Outlets 1,248                          |

---

**37 The Growth Coach** Tech Services

Total investment \$48,000 – \$63,400 Initial fee \$39,900 Royalty 10% Outlets 58 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**38 Liberty Tax Service** Tax Financial

Total investment \$49,700 – \$71,400 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 14% Outlets 3,326 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**39 BEST BRAINS** Education

Total investment \$49,850 – \$134,300 Initial fee \$0 Royalty 14% Outlets 490

---

**40 ESTRELLA INSURANCE** Tax Financial

Total investment \$49,950 – \$84,000 Initial fee \$10,000 Royalty 10%  
Outlets 642 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**41 Eye Level Learning Center** Education

Total investment \$49,968 – \$133,200 Initial fee \$1,000 Royalty — Outlets 363

---

## \$50,000 – \$100,000

---

**42 Oxi Fresh** Home Services Cleaning

Total investment \$50,685 – \$80,740 Initial fee \$44,900 Royalty —  
Outlets 1,424 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**43 Oxi Fresh Carpet Cleaning** Home Services Cleaning

Total investment \$50,700 – \$87,304 Initial fee \$47,900 Royalty —  
Outlets 1,376 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**44 Young Rembrandts** Education

Total investment \$51,375 – \$59,325 Initial fee \$39,500 Royalty 10%  
Outlets 146 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**45 REALTY EXECUTIVES** Real Estate

Total investment \$54,700 – \$443,500 Initial fee \$20,000 Royalty — Outlets 663

---

**46 FIX AUTO** Automotive Services

Total investment \$55,100 – \$850,000 Initial fee \$10,000 Royalty 3%  
Outlets 636 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**47 SHELFGENIE** Home Services Remodeling

Total investment \$55,550 – \$148,350 Initial fee \$35,000 Royalty 5%  
Outlets 810 · [Item 19 disclosed](#)

---

**48 Motto Mortgage** Tax Financial

Total investment \$55,700 – \$239,750 Initial fee \$20,000 Royalty — Outlets 513

---

---

**49 Heaven's Best** Home Services Cleaning

**Total investment** \$55,960 – \$110,100    **Initial fee** \$36,000    **Royalty** —    **Outlets** 1,294

---

**50 CORE Group Restoration** Home Services Restoration

**Total investment** \$56,350 – \$373,710    **Initial fee** \$25,000    **Royalty** —    **Outlets** 108

---

## Next steps

---

Build your shortlist from this list, then on [franchisedepth.com](https://franchisedepth.com): open each brand page for the full Item 5/6/7/19/20 data, run the per-brand cost calculator, and compare brands side-by-side. For the diligence playbook, grab the free [FDD Buyer's Checklist](#).

Compiled May 2026 from 2026 (and most-recent) FDD filings. Rankings update as new filings are ingested — the live database at [franchisedepth.com](https://franchisedepth.com) is always current.